Despite mass migration in particular sectors, the USA was not a destination in the Great Indian Migration Wave because migration was more permanent and gender-balanced in nature. This led to the emergence of a large second-generation Indian-American population facing all the challenges of assimilation from choosing names to fitting in with society, as was eloquently described in Jhumpa Lahiri's *Namesake*, to earning sobriquets of being branded as American Born Confused Desis (ABCDs) by the Indians. It involves understanding baseball more than cricket and Hollywood more than Bollywood.

The people of Indian origin in America today are a diverse group in terms of language, class and religion, but not so much in terms of caste. They are Democrat-leaning in terms of political preferences and have diversified occupations through entrepreneurship.[37] They could be born in India, the USA or anywhere else in the world and collectively number over 3 million, forming 1 per cent of the US population. The USA, in fact, hosts the largest Indian diaspora as over a 1,00,000 Indians continue to emigrate there every year. India has also emerged as the second largest source of immigrants in the US, next only to Mexico. Poor and undocumented Indian workers do exist by the thousands, but their stories are rarely heard in the general narrative of Indian success. The Indians in the USA are known for the premium they place on education, hard work, culture and, perhaps more controversially, on thrift, like modern-day Boston Brahmins. The tag of being the 'most undesirable of all Asiatics' has been put to rest.

Like the Indian community in the USA, the million strong Indian community of Canada is also a model minority group—well-educated and entrepreneurial—representing around 4 per cent of the Canadian population. They mostly reside in Toronto in the east and Vancouver in the west. But the Indians in Canada are less likely to belong to Gujarat or Andhra Pradesh as in the USA and more likely to belong to a few districts of eastern Punjab that belong to the Great Indian Migration Wave.

The Punjabi link with Canada (pronounced as 'Kuhnedda' in Punjabi) stems from a variety of reasons that go back to the early 20th century. In 1902, Punjabi Sikhs of the British Indian army in Hong Kong sailed to